

Looking for files

Searching for files on a computer is similar to finding them in a real-world filing cabinet. The file system on a computer is usually accessed using a window containing small icons of folders or documents. A folder can be opened to display the files inside by touching with a finger on a touchscreen or double-clicking with a mouse or trackpad.



△ Searching for files

The best way to look for a file is to find the magnifying glass icon. Then, click on it and type the filename or keywords in the search bar.



.jpg



**Image
viewer**



.docx



**Text
viewer**

△ Opening files

A filename usually includes a full stop followed by some letters. This is the file extension, which identifies the type of file and tells the computer what kind of program it should use to open it.



△ In the bin

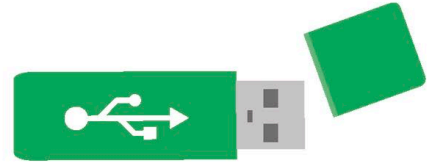
Deleting a file by mistake is quite common. Deleted files usually go into the recycle or trash bin, and can be restored by opening the bin and taking the file out.

Moving data

There are various ways to transfer data between computers. Emails can be used to attach pictures, documents, and other files to a message. There are also systems, such as Google Drive or Dropbox that allow people to upload large files and folders to the cloud. These can be shared with others through a link to the uploaded file, which can then be downloaded, or even edited online.



Secure Digital (SD) memory card



USB pen drive

△ Removable storage

You can also move files between computers through storage devices such as USB pen drives and removable hard drives. Data can be stored on memory cards, which can be plugged into computers to be read.

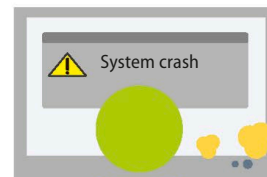


Removable hard drive

REAL WORLD

Saving and backing up

Computers and applications can crash without warning. To avoid losing important work, it's good practice to save a file frequently while working on it. It's also useful to back up files using either a separate hard disk or an online backup service. These services are a part of cloud computing, where people use the storage facilities of a specialist provider to save data.



**At least my data is saved
on the cloud!**